Question ID: bef4b1c6

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Advanced Math	Nonlinear equations in one variable and systems of equations in two variables	Medium

Question

$$\frac{55}{x+6} = x$$

What is the positive solution to the given equation?

Correct Answer: 5

Rationale

The correct answer is 5. Multiplying both sides of the given equation by $x + 6$ results in $55 = x(x + 6)$. Applying the distributive property of multiplication to the right-hand side of this equation results in $55 = x^2 + 6x$. Subtracting 55 from both sides of this equation results in $0 = x^2 + 6x - 55$. The right-hand side of this equation can be rewritten by factoring. The two values that multiply to -55 and add to 6 are 11 and -5. It follows that the equation $0 = x^2 + 6x - 55$ can be rewritten as $0 = (x + 11)(x - 5)$. Setting each factor equal to 0 yields two equations: $x + 11 = 0$ and $x - 5 = 0$. Subtracting 11 from both sides of the equation $x + 11 = 0$ results in $x = -11$. Adding 5 to both sides of the equation $x - 5 = 0$ results in $x = 5$. Therefore, the positive solution to the given equation is 5.